

1A INT. FITZROY'S DRESSING ROOM

1A

Fitzroy Cunningham, a charismatic motivational speaker in his 40s, stands in front of his cellphone camera, filming a vertical video, directly addressing his followers.

He's dressed in a slick **suit, pink tie, pocket square, tie clip** a **wearable headset**, and a **flashy watch**, exuding confidence. We are seeing the POV of his **iPhone** as he's recording the video himself.

FITZROY

(to phone camera)

Hey Strugglers!

How are you doing? How's the family? How did you get out of bed this morning, did you count your blessings? Are you excited for tonight? Are you ready? Are you already out there in the audience? Leave a comment if you are, leave a heart, a thumbs up, let me know!

(big smile - pause)

Tonight is going to be big, isn't it?

Tonight we are going to take control of our actions. We are going to drive our narrative, we are going to show everyone how we make things happen!

I can feel it, I can feel it here in my soul! I can feel the energy coming straight from the other side of that wall! We sold out the venue, can you believe that? I am...

I am blessed.

I call it a blessing... I have a mission.

I'm not here to work - well, obviously, we are entrepreneurs, of course you are paying to be here - I mean, in life what doesn't cost anything is not worth anything... when we organise free events people barely show up.(beat) The more you pay, the more you show up. The more you pay, the more you take notes, but that's right, that's how it is, that's how we work as human beings. But I'm here because I have a mission - that's what drives me, that's what moves me, that's what gets me out of bed every morning. For me, getting back what I have learned, what I have gained from this industry, this profession, this mindset - is my purpose in life.

And this community that we have built, this family, this unstop...

VRRRRRRRRR VRRRRRRRRR

His phone starts vibrating loudly, interrupting the recording, the notification on the screen informs us that "LISA" is calling.

2A INT. FITZROY'S DRESSING ROOM

2A

We cut from his phone camera to a handheld shot of Fitzroy, revealing that he is sitting in front of a **Hollywood mirror** in a shabby **changing room**.

Next to the mirror, we can see a **poster** depicting a smiling Fitzroy, it reads in giant letters: "THE CONTROL MANIFESTO. AN EVENING WITH FITZROY CUNNINGHAM."

Fitzroy lets out a subtle sigh before hesitantly answering the call from his ex-wife.

FITZROY
(into phone)
Hi Liz, I'm busy right now, what's up?

Fitzroy is listening to Lisa's answer - inaudible to us, there is poor reception in the room and he is struggling to hear what she is saying. His forced smile quickly disappears as we see his mind racing.

FITZROY (CONT'D)
Hold on you're breaking up.
(a beat.)
What? What do you mean - of course
I can't...

Lisa replies interrupting him.

FITZROY (CONT'D)
Did you ask your mum? Can't she
like...

Lisa interrupts him again.

FITZROY (CONT'D)
I don't know, ok? It's not like I
can just...
I can't hear you, you're breaking
up! Hold on... hello? Hello??

The line drops.

FITZROY (CONT'D)
Fuck...

It's quite hot in the room and Fitzroy is starting to
sweat.

From just outside the door we can hear some **loud techno music** being played from a speaker, quickly followed by the sound of a **loud drill** on the wall.

Visibly annoyed, Fitzroy calls Emma, his present girlfriend while moving around the room trying to get a better signal.

After dialing, he retrieves from his pocket a **disposable vape** and takes a deep, protracted inhale from it.

FITZROY
(into phone)
Hey Emma, it's me - listen, there's
been a little situation here,
nothing to worry about, we are
going to take care of this you and
me. I just need you to... hello?

The call drops again.

FITZROY (CONT'D)
(angry at the phone)
For fuck's sake!

Right next to the door, we see **the Repairman** (18, chewing a gum, **baggy clothes**, **Airpods**, completely unbothered, doesn't want to be there) He is **drilling** the wall - a **portable speaker** sits by his feet blasting the music we have been hearing. He doesn't seem to be doing anything particularly useful other than drilling the wall. Fitzroy glances at him condescendingly.

FITZROY

(to Ana)

What the hell is going on here?

ANA

Oh, they're fixing the AC...

FITZROY

(to the repairman)

How's it looking, mate? It's pretty warm in here...

REPAIRMAN

(tapping his earbud)

Uh?

FITZROY

(louder)

I said, are you gonna manage to fix it?

REPAIRMAN

(A long beat.) Yeah...

He taps his earbud again and resumes the drilling.

Irked, Fitzroy is about to say something but Ana just interrupts him

ANA

Come on let's go.

They start walking together through the long narrow corridors of the venue.

4 INT. THE CORRIDORS

4

ANA

(going through her **notes**)

So, like we said, you will be waiting right behind the stage door, there's a big sign just in front of it, you can't miss it...

As he turns another corner he sees the repairman, sitting on the floor scrolling on his **phone**, the speaker is off.

FITZROY
(to the repairman)
Keep up the great work, mate.

The repairman looks at him with a completely blank face, then goes back to his phone.

Fitzroy then heads towards the stage, he is rehearsing with confidence his lines.

As he turns a corner, he collides with the **stage hand** (20) holding Fitzroy's beetroot shot, causing it to spill on his jacket.

FITZROY
(angrily)
Are you fucking kidding me?!

STAGE HAND
Oh my god I-I'm so sorry... I
didn't see you...

FITZROY
Just get out!

The stagehand scurries away.

Fitzroy has a meltdown and charges back towards his changing room, cursing under his breath. The phone starts buzzing again. Loud music and drilling resume louder than ever.

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VRRRRRRRRRRRRRRRRRRRRRRRRRRRRR VRRRRRRRRRRRRRRRRRRRRRRRRRRRRR
VRRRRRRRRRRRRRRRRRRRRRRRRRRRRR VRRRRRRRRRRRRRRRRRRRRRRRRRRRRR
VRRRRRRRRRRRRRRRRRRRRRRRRRRRRR VRRRRRRRRRRRRRRRRRRRRRRRRRRRRR
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8 INT. THE CORRIDORS

8

Ana chases him across the corridor.

ANA
What happened?! Where are you
going?!

FITZROY
(panicking)
That's it! I'm done, call it off.

ANA

Still wide-eyed, he takes his jacket off, rolls up his sleeves, adjusts his mic, and walks towards the stage.

9 INT. BACKSTAGE - BEHIND THE STAGE DOOR

9

Fitzroy reaches the back of the stage, he is standing just behind big door, a shining "STAGE" sign illuminates the otherwise dark space. The restless crowd is audible on the other side. We can hear Ana's voice booming through the speakers.

ANA (O.S.)
(from the speakers)
Entrepreneur, Author, Teacher,
Trainer, Speaker, Father.

After a stellar career as a professional Networker, reaching the pinnacle of his profession, he could not stand still and enjoy the fruits of his hard work.

His strong belief in "playing it forward" lead him to devote his time to his fellow "strugglers", weaving a network of compassion and care, of freedom and purpose. He is here tonight to share with us his knowledge, his love and his destiny.

Ladies and gentlemen, get ready for an incredible night of growth, inspiration and transformation.

Please welcome, FITZROY CUNNINGHAM.

We push in on Fitzroy, his smile growing wider and wider. Just as he is called on stage, we hear a strong buzz from his phone.

VRRRRRRRRRRRRRRRRRRRRRRRRRRR VRRRRRRRRRRRRRRRRRRRRRRRRRRR

He hesitates for a fraction of a second.

Cheesy triumphant music begins playing, the crowd roars.

SMASH TO TITLE CARD

.M O T I V A T I O N A L.

Credits.